

Hemicidaris

HEM-ee-sid-AR-is



- **When** 176–65 million years ago (Middle Jurassic to Late Cretaceous)
- **Fossil location** England
- **Habitat** Rocky seabeds
- **Size** Including spines 8 in (20 cm) diameter
Without spines $\frac{3}{4}$ –1½ in (2–4 cm)

Fossils of *Hemicidaris* are covered with bumps where its vicious, 3 in (8 cm) long spines were attached. These were flexible, allowing *Hemicidaris* to move its spines with muscles. It lived on firm seabeds and used its sticky feet to creep around.



Attachment point for spine

LIVING RELATIVE

Sea urchins are small, ball-shaped creatures that often have prickly, even poisonous spines for protection. They creep slowly across the seafloor using dozens of tiny sticky feet.



Pentacrinites

PEN-ta-CRINE-ee-tees



- **When** 208–135 million years ago (Jurassic)
- **Fossil location** Europe
- **Habitat** Open seas
- **Size** Arms up to 31 in (80 cm) long

Pentacrinites was a crinoid (sea lily) as tall as a man and lived rooted to one spot by a stalk, catching food in its feathery arms. Its hundreds of densely packed arms made it look more like a beautiful plant than an animal. Its fossils are often found with fossilized wood, suggesting that the creature may sometimes have attached itself to floating driftwood.

